

# Trinidad & Tobago

**Ratio:** 3:5 **Adopted:** August 31, 1962 **Usage:** National and Civil

*White represents  
the sea*



*Black symbolizes  
the strength of  
the people*

*Red stands for  
the people*

North America



**Trinidad and Tobago** were separate British colonies, which united in 1889. They became independent in 1962 and a republic in 1976.

The flag adopted at independence was chosen from among designs sent in by the public. The same colors are used in the arms.

A flag for HM Queen Elizabeth II was adopted after independence, but it became obsolete following the formation of the republic.

The President has a flag of blue with the arms in the center. The coat

of arms depicts the three ships of Columbus who landed here in 1498.

Above the ships are two golden hummingbirds. The supporters of the coat of arms are also local birds and the whole shield stands on a scene depicting waves breaking against the rocky coasts of the islands.

Trinidad also has flags for the Prime Minister and other ministers.

## THE PRESIDENT'S FLAG

*The top of the  
shield depicts two  
hummingbirds*

*The scarlet ibis is one  
of many local birds*



*The cocrico—  
a local bird*

*In 1498 Columbus  
discovered Trinidad  
and his ships appear  
on the shield*